

Anti-Red Bills Held Road to Police State

By The Associated Press

The Civil Rights Congress contended before a House committee yesterday that proposed anti-Communist legislation represents "a dangerous short-cut to thought control and a police state."

The Rev. Clarence Parker of Chicago, an Episcopal minister, spoke for the organization at a hearing by the House Un-American Activities Committee on pending anti-Communist measures.

Asked by Frank Tavenner, jr., committee counsel, whether he knew the Civil Rights Congress has been designated as subversive by the Attorney General and the committee, Parker replied:

"I am aware of that."

Parker said he regards a bill by Representative Nixon (R., Calif.), which the committee is considering, as unconstitutional. A similar

bill, sponsored by Senators Mundt (R., S. Dak.) and Ferguson (R., Mich.) is pending in the Senate.

Under the bills, members of the Communist Party and organizations designated as Communist "fronts" would be required to register and account for their income. Parker said these registrations would constitute a "public blacklist."

"If this bill becomes a law, the consequences will be very serious for a large number of people," he said. "The membership of organizations listed as subversive runs into the millions."

Answering a question by Representative Kearney (R., N. Y.), Parker said he does not feel the listing of the Civil Rights Congress by the Attorney General "makes us subversive."